

death_rnr — LSO 2026 Post-Event Review

Version 1.0 · 2026-08-06

Version 1.0 · 2026-08-06 · Imperial Knights, "This List Tastes Like Death by Rock and Roll"

Post-mortem of the Lone Star Open 2026 (328 players, 6 rounds), built from the real BCP results

([data/bcp/lso2026-placings.json](#), [-pairings.json](#)) cross-referenced against our pre-event

archetype verdicts and the death_rnr field dossier.

Headline

- **Event winner:** Junior Afleje — Leagues of Votann (Priority Assets).
- **Joe / death_rnr: 2-4, 244/328** (Imperial Knights, Valourstrike Lance, Purge the Foe).
- **Two other Knights top-6:** Jason Weeks **4th (6-0)**, Nathaniel Bjorge **6th (5-1)** — the list

archetype top-cuts; death_rnr's run underperformed the field's Knights.

1. Did our verdicts hold up?

Our verdicts rate **how death_rnr fares vs an archetype** (not the archetype's raw strength). Tested against actual finishes, the archetypes we flagged **UNFAVOURABLE** (hardest for Knights) were the genuine top of the field:

Archetype	Our read	Actual avg finish	Best
Dark Angels — Company of Hunters	UNFAVOURABLE	80	2nd
T'au — Experimental Prototype	UNFAVOURABLE	93	10th
Necrons — Cursed Legion	UNFAVOURABLE	118	23rd
Votann — Needgaard	COIN-FLIP	126	1st
Custodes — Shield Host	FAVOURABLE	170	109th

Threat-assessment was **directionally correct** — the invuln-negation / Dev-wound / out-OC lists we called hardest finished highest; the FAVOURABLE pick (Custodes) was a weak meta choice.

Caveat: verdict *tier* is not a power ranking — e.g. Necrons Awakened Dynasty (C'tan wall) is

HARD *for us* yet finished low overall (avg 197). Use verdicts as matchup guidance, not tiering.

Joe's 6 games vs our reads

		Re s	Score	Opponent archetype	Our read
1	L		72- 73	DA — Wrath of the Rock	HARD → lost by 1
2	W		89- 61	Necrons — Hand of the Dynasty (C'tan)	HARD → won (play-the-mission worked)
3	W		97- 86	Chaos Space Marines	—
4	L		82- 92	DA — Librarian Conclave	COIN-FLIP → close L
5	L		33- 98	Imperial Knights (mirror)	MIRROR → blown out
6	L		73- 84	Grey Knights — Banishers	COIN-FLIP → close L

Reads were sound: the two HARD games were a 1-point loss and a win; four of six were within ~11.

The killer was the **mirror blowout (33-98)**, which also tanked tiebreakers.

2. The whole Knights field (18 players) — what wins

Plc	Re c	Player	Disposition	Detachment	Build	Lance r
4	6- 0	Jason Weeks	Take and Hold	Gate Warden Lance	4 Kn + 3 Armiger + Sisters/Immolator	no
6	5- 1	Nathaniel Borge	Priority Assets	Valourstrike	5 gun-Knights (pure)	no
31	5- 1	Lewis Hersman	Purge the Foe	Valourstrike	4 Kn + 2 Armiger	no
40	4- 2	Dick McTrickle	Purge the Foe	Valourstrike	3 Kn + 5 Armiger	no
68	4- 2	Gator Murray	Purge the Foe	Valourstrike	4 Kn + Lancer + allies	yes
13 8	3- 3	Chad Stubblefield	Purge the Foe	Valourstrike	5 Kn (pure)	no
...		(mid-pack)				mixe d
24 4	2- 4	Joe Beddoe	Purge the Foe	Valourstrike	3 Kn + Lancer + Warglaive + Navigator	yes
28	1-	Lacey Huff	Reconnaissanc	Dominus	2 Kn + 8 Armiger	no

1	4		e	Foebreakers		
29	1-	Alex Hernandez	Purge the Foe	Valourstrike	5 Kn + Lancer	yes
8	4					
31	0-	Corbin King	Purge the Foe	Valourstrike	2 Kn + 8 Armiger	no
7	3					

The signal, ranked by strength:

1. **Cerastus Lancer = the clearest negative.** No-Lancer avg **134** vs Lancer avg **225** (n=10 vs 8);

all top-4 Knights ran no Lancer; best Lancer finish was 68th. The ~415-pt melee investment is the

"Castellan's worth of shooting" our firepower-as-denial law warned against — the field confirms it.

(Correlation, n=18 — not proof, but consistent and doctrine-aligned.)

2. **Disposition = secondary.** Objective disps (166) only mildly beat Purge (181); Purge/no-Lancer players still placed 31st & 40th. Purge wasn't the problem — the Lancer + build were.

3. **Two proven winning shapes, both Lancer-less, max firepower/board:** all-gun 5-Questoris (Bjorge) OR guns + cheap OC bodies (Weeks: Armigers + Sisters/Immolator). Allies help but aren't required.

4. **death_rnr combined the worst-correlated traits** — the Lancer + a thin board (only a Warglaive + Navigator for OC) — on the kill-primary disposition.

3. Recommendations for the next event

- **Drop the Cerastus Lancer.** Reinvest into either a 5th gun-Knight (Bjorge model) or Armigers + a cheap OC/action ally package (Weeks model). This is the single highest-leverage change.

- **Add real board/OC presence** if going the Weeks route (Armigers + a Sisters squad + Immolator) — it directly fixes the "always outnumbered, lose the primary" problem.

- **Disposition is a lighter lever** — Take and Hold / Priority Assets edged Purge, but a good no-Lancer Purge list still top-30s. Decide disposition by the build, not the reverse.

- **Mirror prep matters** — a Knights mirror decided by first turn + Rotate discipline swung Joe's event (33-98). The all-gun build wins the mirror (Bjorge 100-69); the Lancer build lost it.

The pre-event verdicts + field dossier were sound as matchup intel; the list-construction was the gap. Both winning Knights builds point the same way: more guns/board, no Lancer.